



FOOD FOR THOUGHT

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Why every sport needs its own meal plan

For elite performers, nutrition is not just about wellness but also about **fuelling, recovering, and repeating.**

A sprinter doesn't eat like a marathon runner. A cricketer's diet won't suit a wrestler. And a swimmer's pre-race meal is vastly different from that of a gymnast. Why? Because sports nutrition is never one-size-fits-all. It's a detailed science that adapts to the unique demands of each sport.

Over the years, working with athletes from different disciplines — from Olympic wrestlers to international cricketers, swimmers to badminton champs — one thing has become crystal clear to me. Eating 'healthy' is not the same as eating 'right'. For elite performers, nutrition is not just about wellness. It's about fuelling, recovering, and repeating.

Sometimes all in one day.

Every sport places a different kind of stress on the body. Some demand explosive power. Others require long-lasting endurance. Some need agility and precision. Each of these needs calls for a tailored approach to food.

Let's explore how nutrition varies based on the sport.

Brutal harmony: Sports like gymnastics demand strength, control, and aesthetic appearance. Gymnasts often maintain low body fat and high flexibility, making nutrient density critical. GETTY IMAGES